3°

I took a course in the summer of 1947 on advanced organic theory. It was designed to help bring me up to date on the new theories that had taken over in my absence during the war. These represented the ap-

plication of quantum mechanics to organic chemistry, the use of electronic formulas and of the phenomenon of "resonance," which stabilized certain chemical configurations and not others, the studies of reaction intermediates, and the prediction of the course of chemical change in the light of such things.

All these had made their appearance before the war, even as long ago as in Linus Pauling's The Nature of the Chemical Bond, which was first published in 1932. The notions had been penetrating the schools only slowly, however, and had then suddenly saturated instruction during the war years—just in time for me to miss it.

It's not surprising, then, that I had a difficult time with it, as did most of the class, and in the end I took a cowardly H (which simply meant "attended" and involved neither mark nor credit), as did most of the class.

In addition to taking the course, I spent the summer of 1947 making endless calculations concerning my chronometric observations. I was trying to find the most satisfactory theories, the clearest explanations of what was happening—in short, the best possible way of arranging my forthcoming dissertation.

And I also spent it on "Grow Old with Me." On August 3, I began to put the accumulated first draft into final copy. By August 27, I had quite a bit of it in final copy and took it in to Merwin for an interim report, so to speak. Again, he wanted to read it. I called him the next day and again found he liked it. He urged me to continue at full speed.

Windsor Place Again

On August 10, a working telephone was finally installed in our apartment, only eleven months after we had applied for one. It was the first telephone I had ever had that was entirely my own and that did not require that we put a coin into it.

Naturally, it was a wonderful toy to begin with, and we called up everyone we knew that took only a local call.